BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

When checks happen

The columns show order, not equal periods. There is no fixed number of cycles for these plans. Agree who books each check, when results are reviewed and whom to contact if a check is missed.

Check	Before starting	Early treatment	Repeated treatment	Longer-term review	Pause / completion
Blood counts, kidney and liver	Baseline blood count, kidney and liver profile	Review results before treatment	Weekly blood count; kidney and liver tests before each cycle	Repeat sooner if symptoms or results need it	Follow any unresolved abnormal result
Bowel symptoms and hydration	Have a written diarrhoea plan and emergency contact	Tell the nurse about cramps, sweating or diarrhoea during infusion	Delayed diarrhoea can start after the first day; act using your written plan	Fever, reduced urine, severe pain or inability to drink needs urgent advice	Restart decisions require recovery and team review
Cancer response and treatment choices	Record baseline disease and agree review plan	Bring forward review if symptoms worsen	Scans and other tests follow your consultant's treatment plan	Discuss benefit, side effects and whether the goal has changed	Agree continuation, a break, another treatment or supportive care

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00213 v7 · official regimen

Tests in your plan

Carcinoembryonic antigen (CEA) — colorectal plans

If part of your plan

WHEN

For a colorectal cancer plan, if your team uses CEA; your team sets the interval.

A marker trend interpreted alongside symptoms, examination and scans.

Record the baseline, latest result and next date. A marker change alone does not establish progression.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Irinotecan · every three weeks: treatment and checks

Advanced / metastatic colorectal cancer

Irinotecan on Day 1 every 21 days while beneficial and tolerable. There is no home chemotherapy pump. Blood counts are checked weekly, including between infusion visits.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Early treatment	Repeated treatment	Longer-term review	Pause / completion
Blood counts, kidney and liver NCCP 00213	Baseline blood count, kidney and liver profile	Review results before treatment	Weekly blood count; kidney and liver tests before each cycle	Repeat sooner if symptoms or results need it	Follow any unresolved abnormal result
Bowel symptoms and hydration NCCP 00213	Have a written diarrhoea plan and emergency contact	Tell the nurse about cramps, sweating or diarrhoea during infusion	Delayed diarrhoea can start after the first day; act using your written plan	Fever, reduced urine, severe pain or inability to drink needs urgent advice	Restart decisions require recovery and team review
Cancer response and treatment choices NCCP 00213	Record baseline disease and agree review plan	Bring forward review if symptoms worsen	Scans and other tests follow your consultant's treatment plan	Discuss benefit, side effects and whether the goal has changed	Agree continuation, a break, another treatment or supportive care

What each check is for

1 A 21-day reference cycle

Clinic → home → review

The aim is to control advanced bowel cancer and symptoms. The team reviews how well treatment is working and whether side effects remain acceptable; there is no single fixed number of cycles for everyone.

Ask / act: Confirm the phase, prescription, tests and supportive medicines before starting.

Sources: NCCP 00213

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-04 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.33